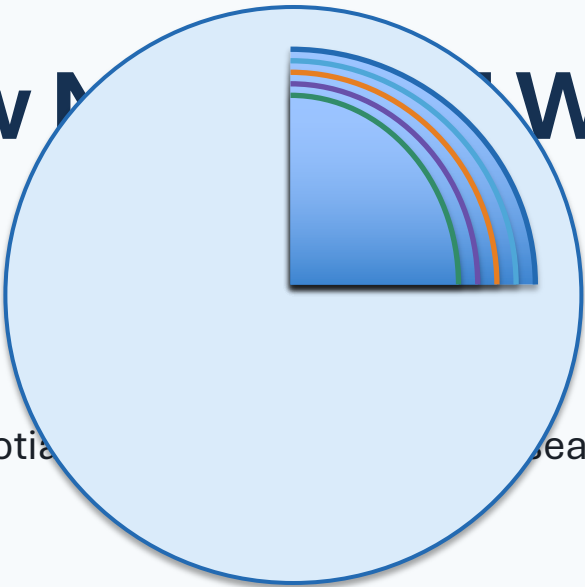


Global CO₂ Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What



Fossil fuels & industry, 1750–2024 — a data-forward briefing for policy analysts, climate negotiators, and researchers.

>35 Bt

global CO₂ annually today

~31%

China share of 2024 global CO₂

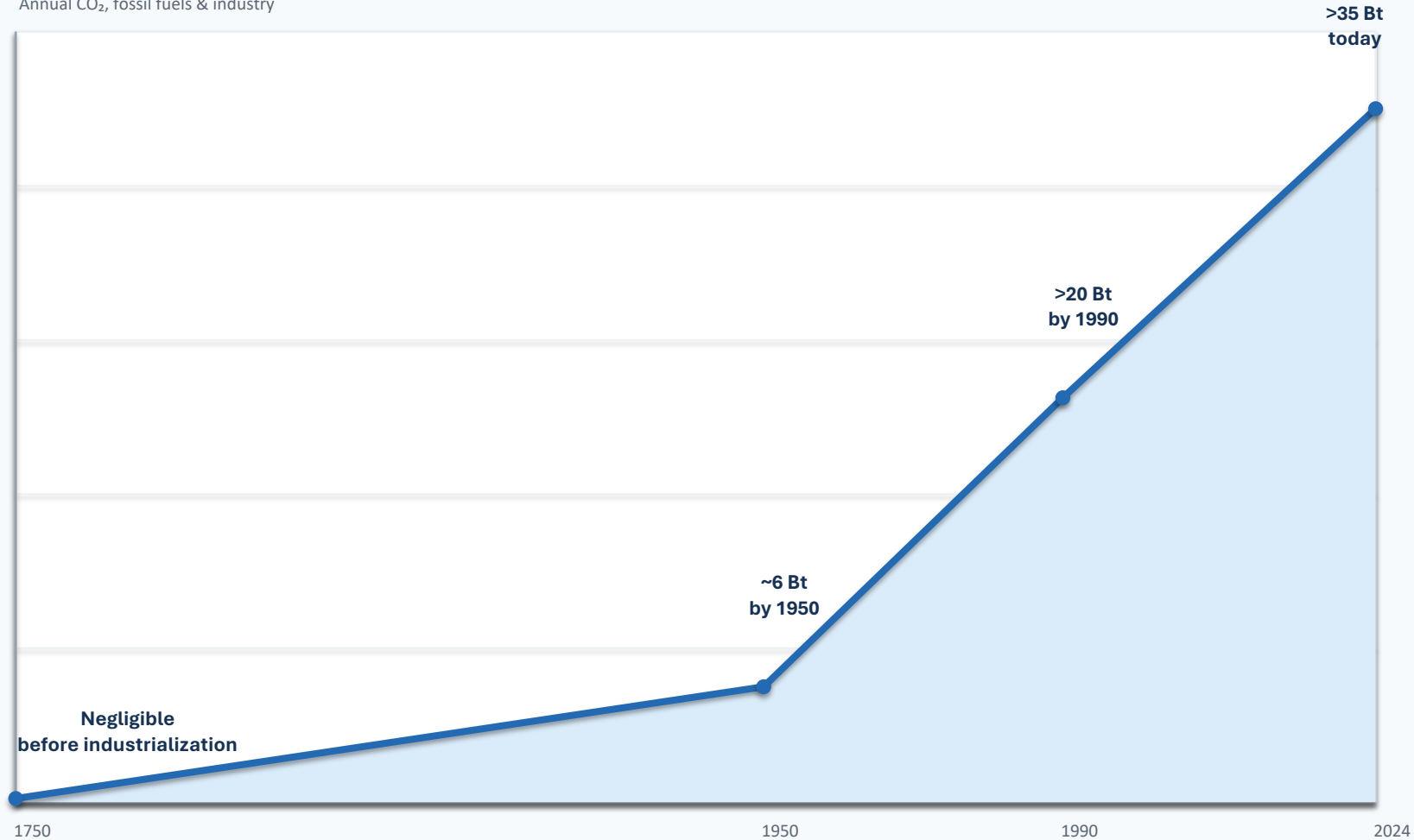
150×

per capita gap: lowest vs highest



Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today

Annual CO₂, fossil fuels & industry

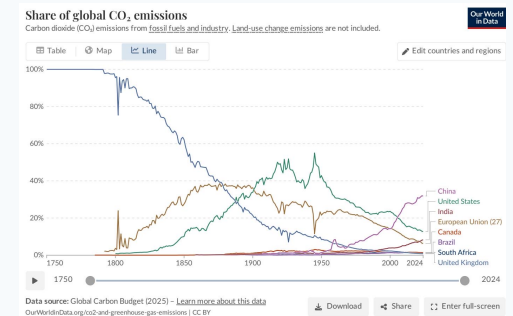


No peak yet

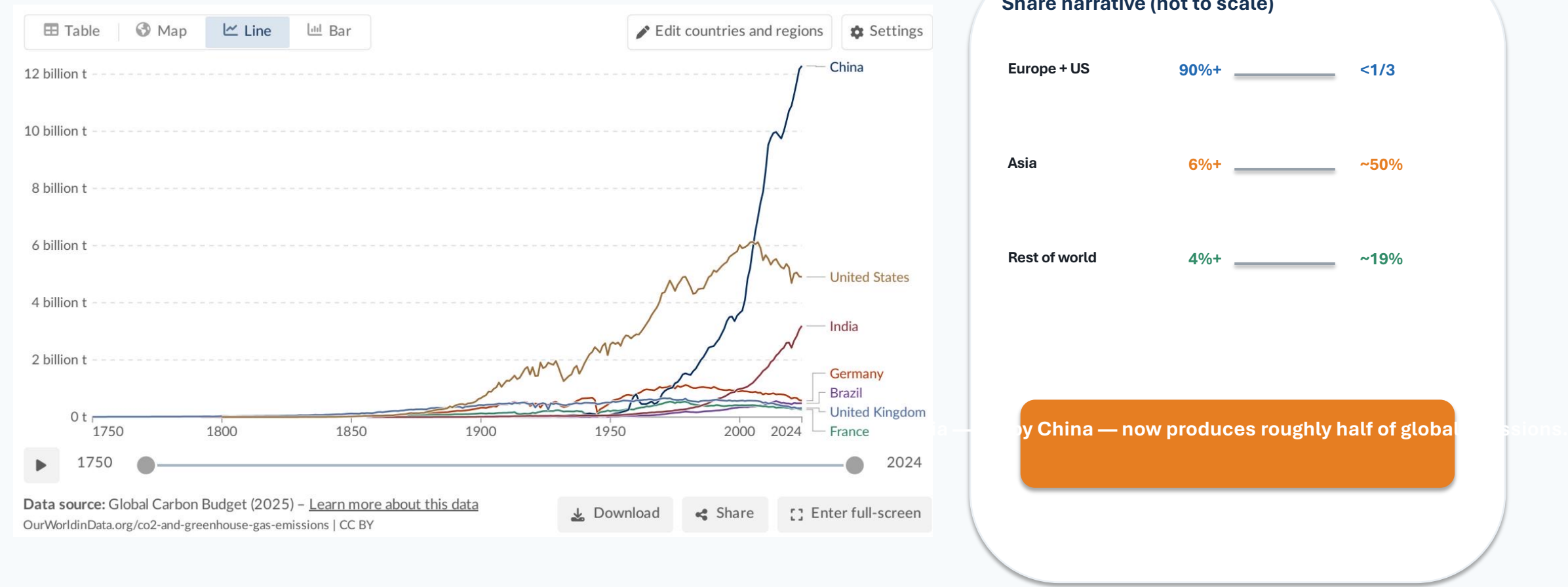
Growth has slowed in recent years, but global fossil fuel and

Fossil fuels dominate

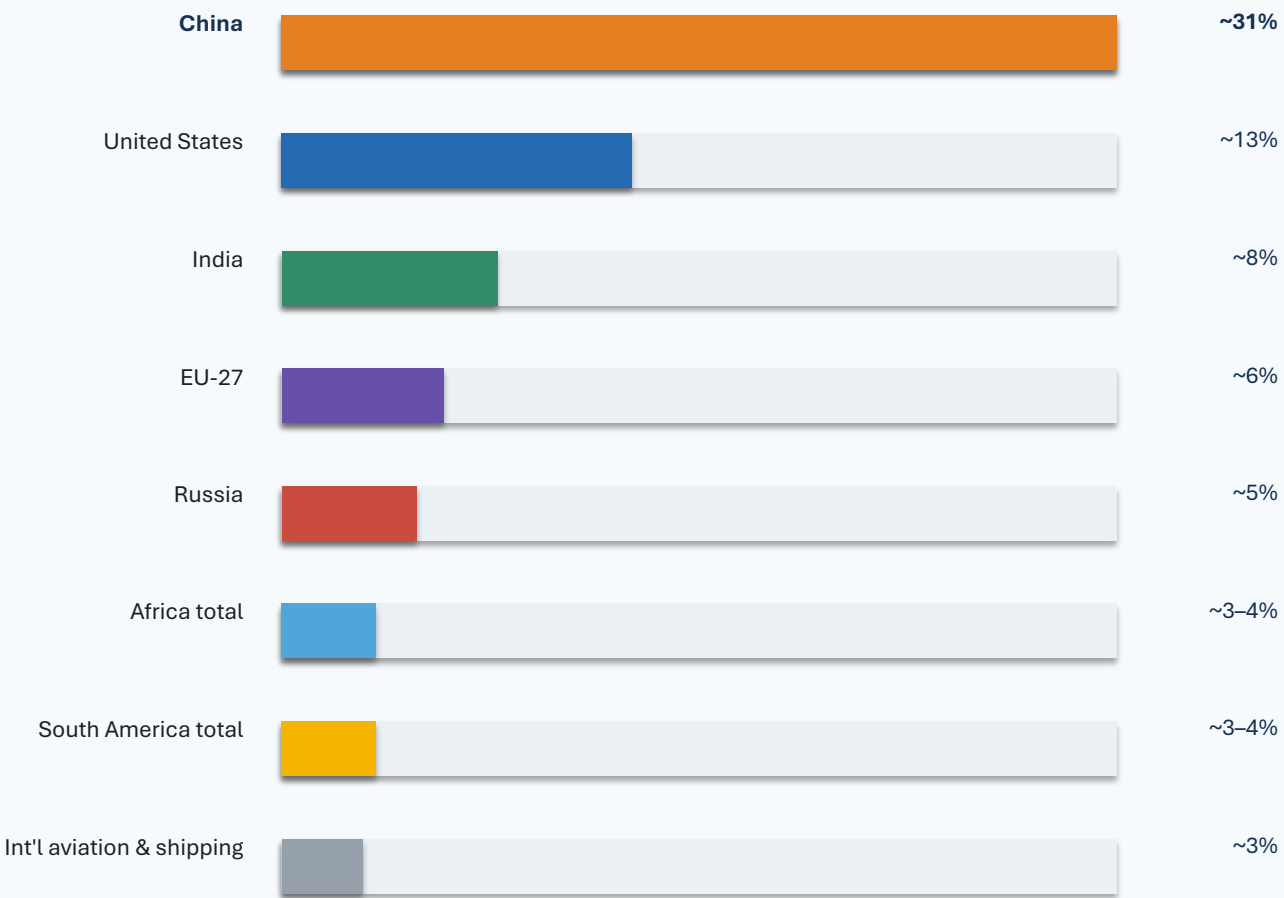
Land-use change emissions have declined slightly, while fo



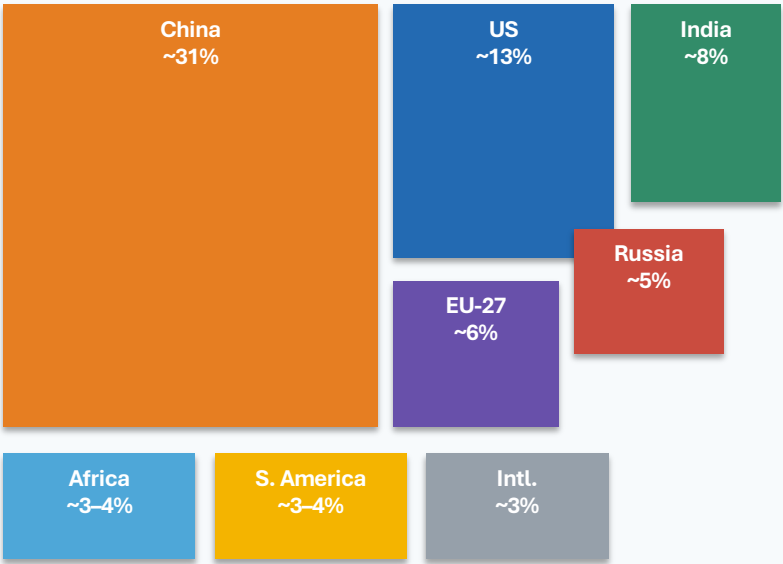
Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today



China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂



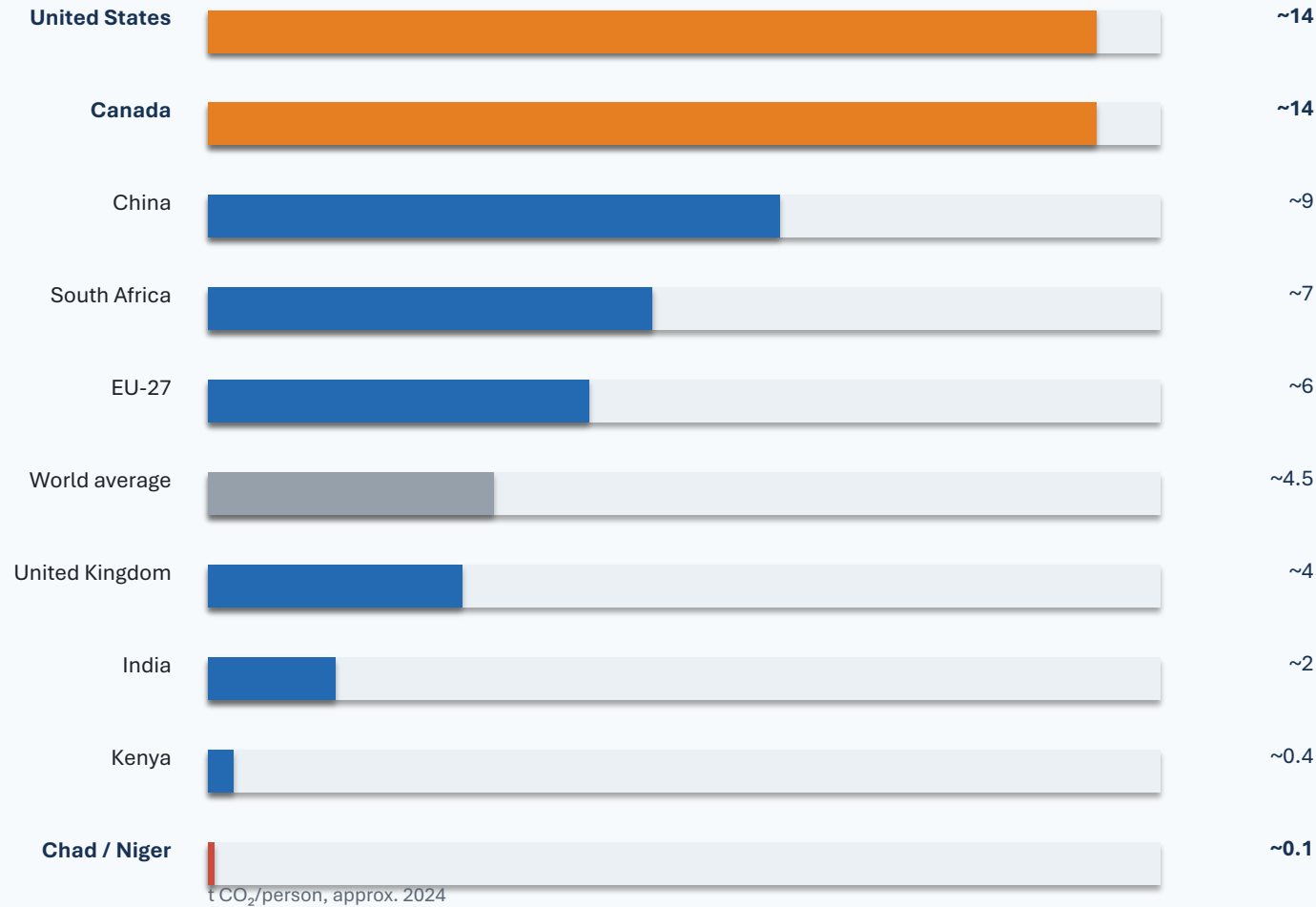
Treemap-style comparison



Scale insight

Africa and South America each contribute only ~3-4% — comparable to international aviation and shipping

Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



≈150× gap

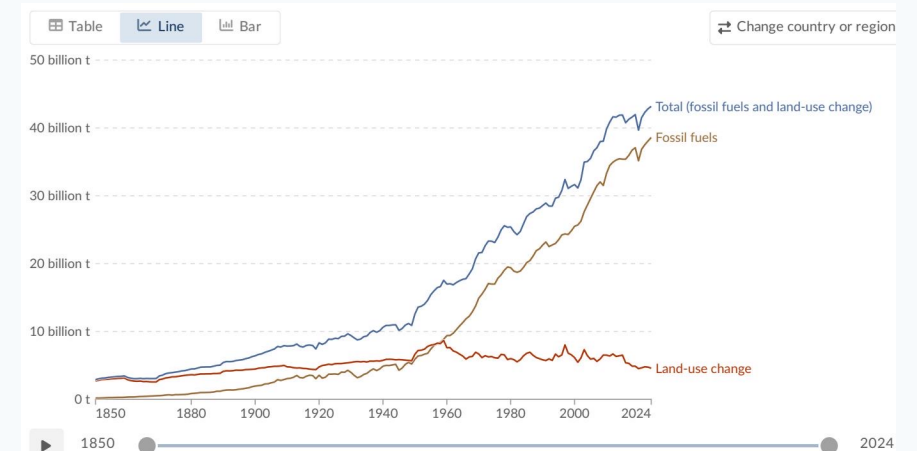
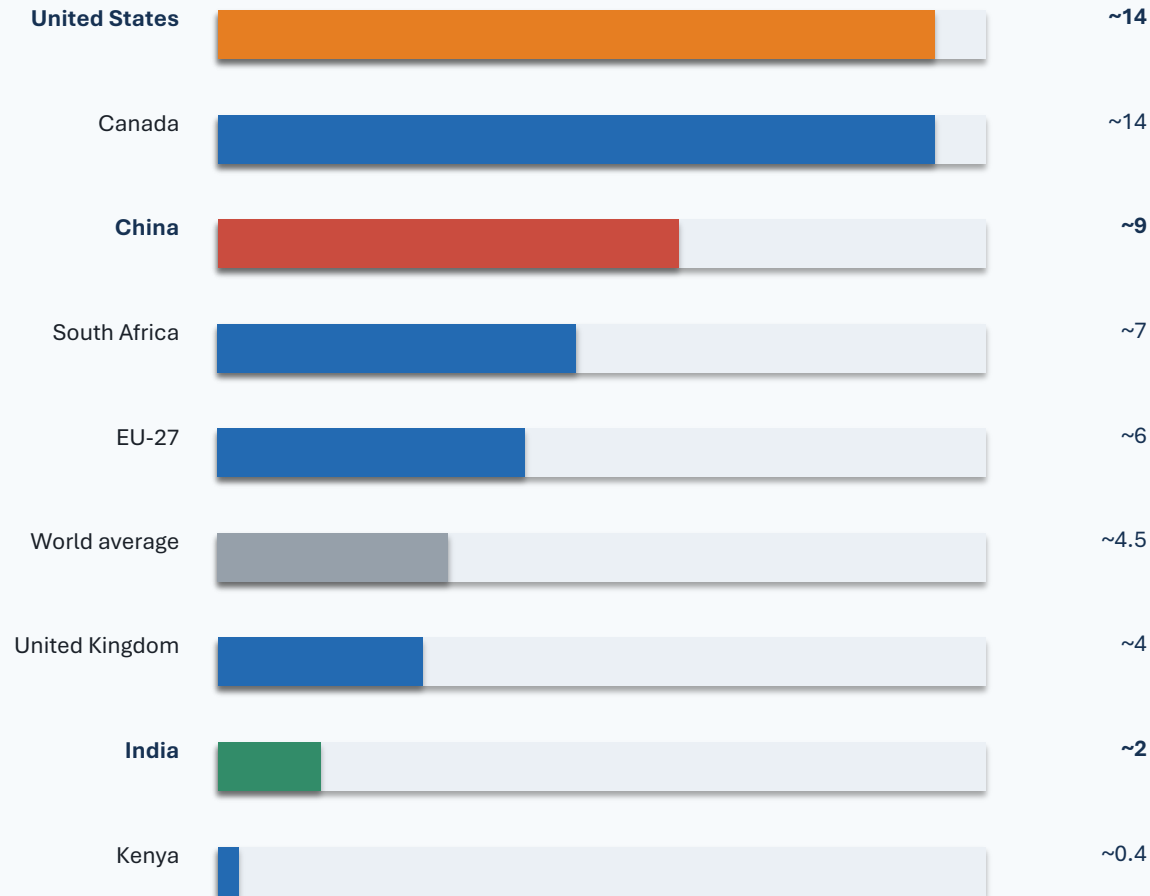
Responsibility reframed

The average American or Australian emits in under two days what

Prosperity ≠ fixed emissions

France and the UK are much lower than the US despite similar liv

Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India



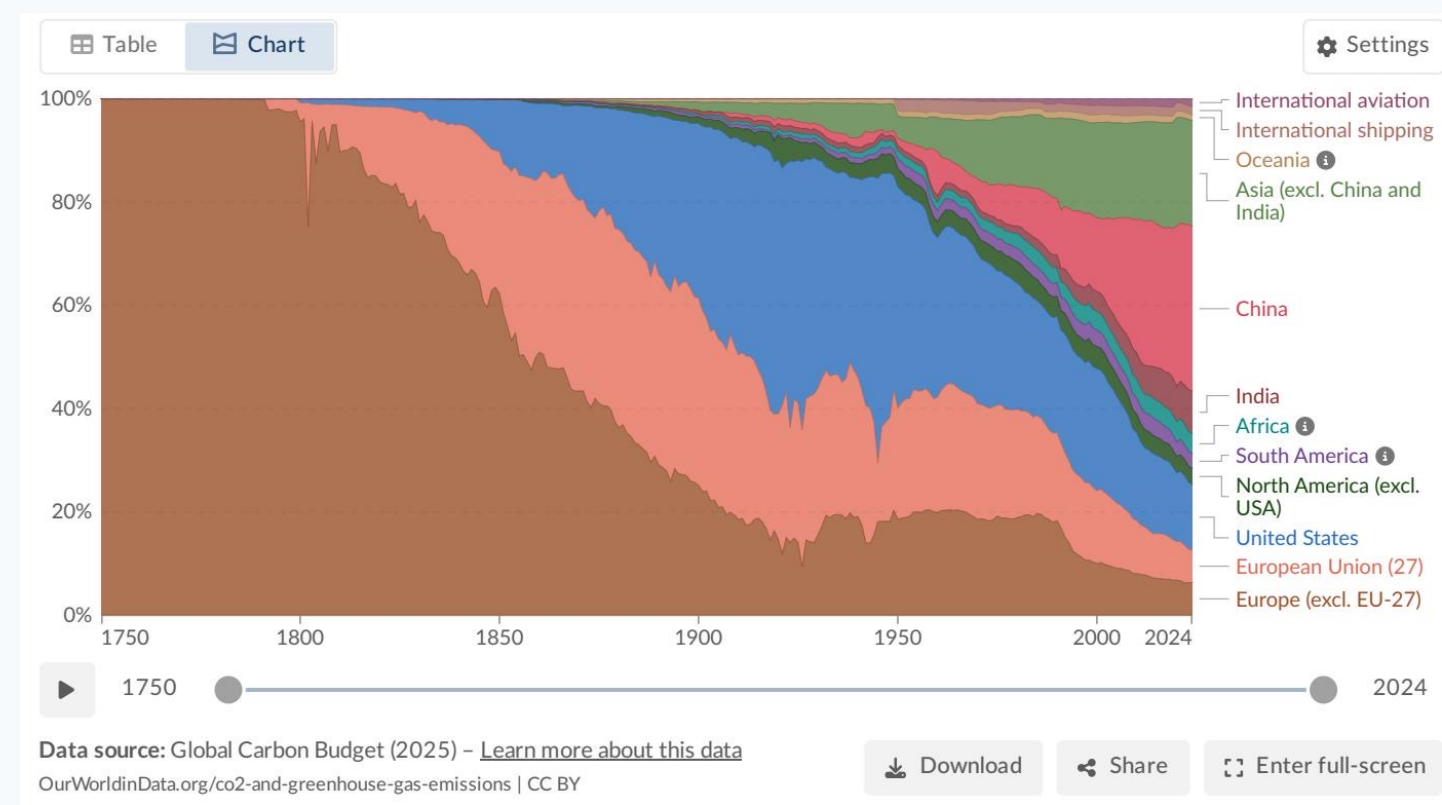
China context

Largest total emitter, but per capita

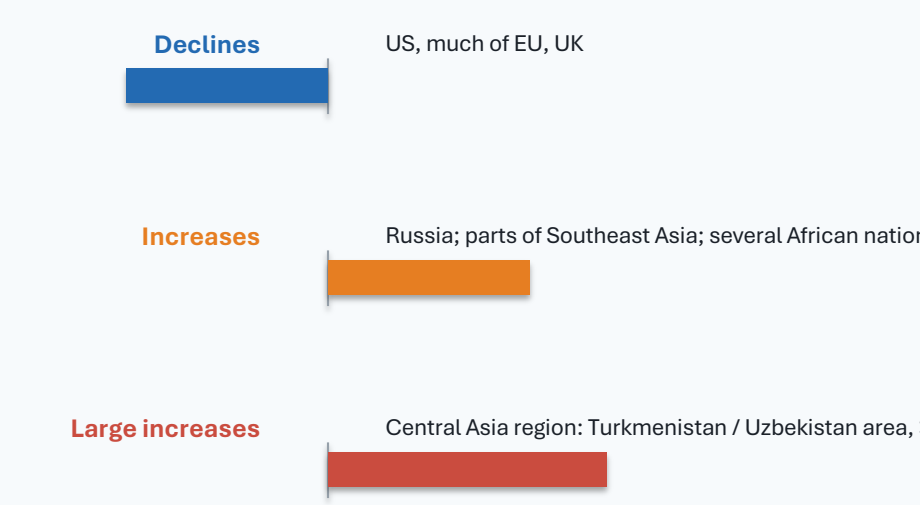
India context

India remains very low at ~2 t/person.

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa



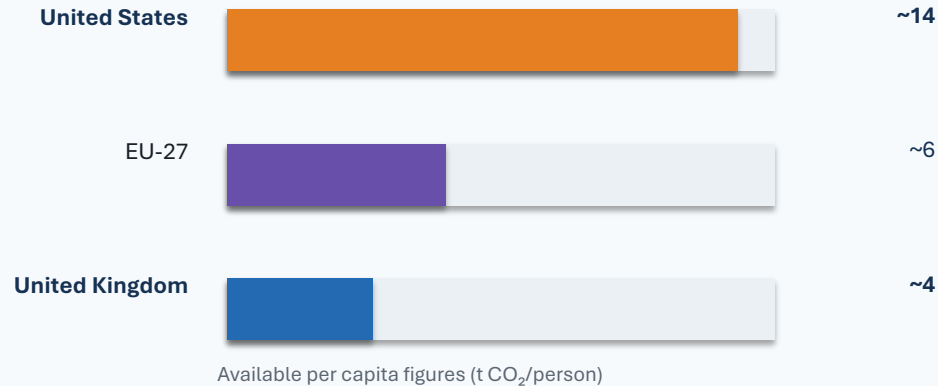
Diverging-bar interpretation



Mixed signals

Developed-country reductions were offset in part by increases in Asia, the

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany



Higher fossil electricity

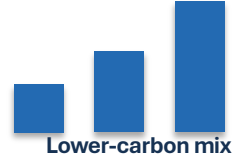
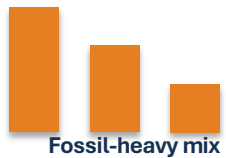
Raises per capita CO₂ in countries such as Germany, the Netherlands, or the US.

Nuclear + renewables

Helps France, the UK, and Portugal emit far less per capita among wealthy nations.

Policy lever

Energy policy and technology choices can decouple prosperity from emissions.



Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

- 1 No peak yet** Global fossil fuel CO₂ exceeds 35 Bt/yr and has not yet peaked.
- 2 Annual dominance shifted** China is the largest annual emitter; Europe and the US fell from >90% in 1900 to less than one-third today.
- 3 Per capita changes the frame** China remains below the US per person; India remains ~2 t/person.
- 4 Inequality is extreme** A 150× gap persists between the lowest emitters and highest large-country emitters.
- 5 Choices matter** Energy policy and technology can decouple prosperity from emissions.

Policy implication: negotiate around both current emissions capacity and unequal historical/per-capita responsibility.